

KIPRE STAFF TRAINING NEEDS ASSESSMENT (TNA) REPORT

Human Resource Division

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Executive Summary

Background

The primary purpose of this Training Needs Analysis (TNA) is to systematically assess institutional competency gaps and evaluate workforce preparedness. This evidence-based approach is designed to inform training priorities and guide strategic human capital development across the KIPRE. The assessment was conducted using a multi-dimensional questionnaire structured into specific modules to capture a holistic view of the workforce. These sections included:

- Basic Information (Directorate, Age, and Sex of the employee)
- Job Role and Responsibilities
- Self Performances Assessing Questions
- Skills and Copetency Assessment
- Training History
- Identification of Training Needs
- Training Delivery Preferences
- Organizational Support
- Future Skills and Emerging Needs
- Additional Comments

By triangulating data from these domains, the analysis identifies not only current skill deficiencies but also the organizational support structures and delivery formats required to bridge them effectively.

Objectives

The primary goal of this assessment was to capture KIPRE employees' perspectives on their work environment, competencies, and developmental needs. By analyzing these self-reported insights, KIPRE can move away from ad-hoc training decisions and build a people-first human capital strategy. Specifically, this assessment aimed to:

- Map perceived skill gaps by uncovering where staff across different directorates, divisions, and job grades feel they lack the technical or administrative confidence to excel.
- Evaluate the felt impact of past training by documenting how effective staff believe previous workshops were and capturing the personal or structural hurdles they feel prevent them from using those skills.
- Capture bottom-up training priorities by listening directly to frontline operational needs and career progression goals to build a highly responsive institutional training roadmap.
- Tailor training delivery to staff preferences by identifying the exact learning formats, durations, and schedules that employees feel would best fit their workflows.
- Identify employee-perceived workplace bottlenecks by revealing the cultural or structural friction points that staff believe are currently limiting their productivity.
- Gauge readiness for future innovations by exploring how prepared and confident the team feels regarding emerging scientific and technological trends in research.

Methodology

The assessment was digitized via ODK Central and deployed from 20th – 28th April of 2026. To ensure we captured a representative voice, we used a multi-channel approach—utilizing official email and professional WhatsApp groups. Participation was voluntary, positioned as a collaborative effort to co-design the organization’s future training roadmap. Data Processing & Analysis Once the collection window closed, raw data was ingested into R (v4.5.2). The analytical pipeline focused on cleaning, recoding qualitative responses for statistical depth, and aggregating the results to provide a granular view of needs across all Directorates and Divisions.

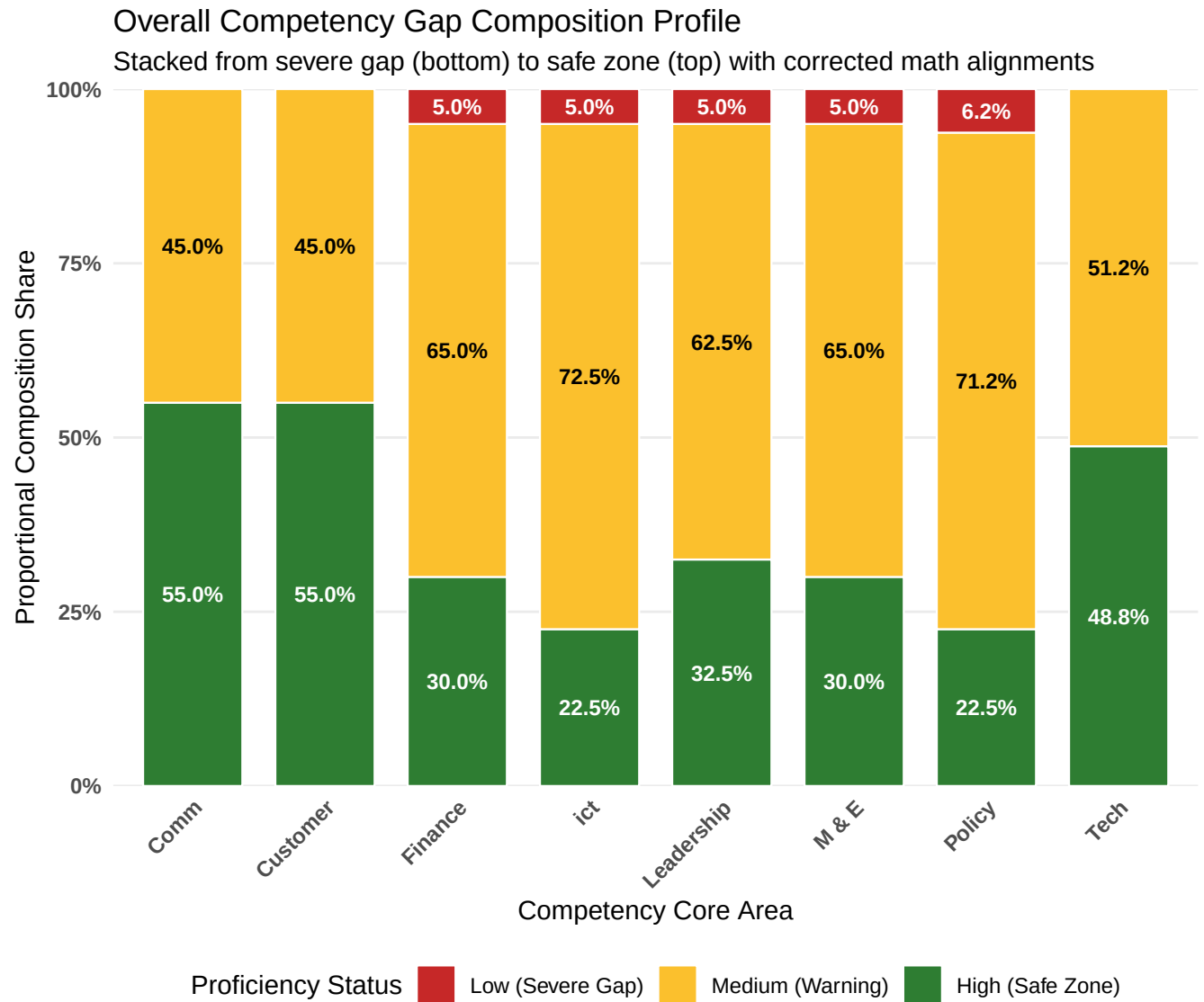
Results

Workforce profile

A total of 80 employees, representing 42% of the 189 staff members currently at KIPRE, participated in this assessment. This respondent base spans 23 distinct divisions (see Table 1) across seven primary Directorates, ensuring the training roadmap reflects both the core scientific mandate and the essential administrative backbone of the institute. The distribution reveals a workforce concentrated within key technical hubs, most notably the Animal Sciences Welfare and Ethics and Research and Product Development Directorates. In the research domain, the Kenya Snakebite Research and Intervention (KSRIC) Division and the Welfare and Ethics (WE) Division emerged as the most represented units. This engagement from frontline technical staff—supported by a demographic where 51.2% of respondents are aged between 25 and 44—provides a robust foundation for identifying gaps in laboratory biosafety and modern research protocols. While the gender distribution is relatively balanced (see Table 2) (45% female, 55% male), distinct generational trends are evident: the female cadre is most concentrated in the 35–44 age bracket (36.1%), whereas the male workforce peaks in the 45–54 bracket (34.1%). Administrative and strategic functions are equally well-mapped, with consistent representation from Corporate Services and the Office of the Director General. Notably, only 10% of respondents are aged 55 or older, indicating a predominantly mid-career workforce with significant long-term growth potential. This demographic profile highlights a strategic opportunity to implement cross-cutting training programmes that standardise administrative excellence and ensure the institution is prepared for future succession and evolving digital demands.

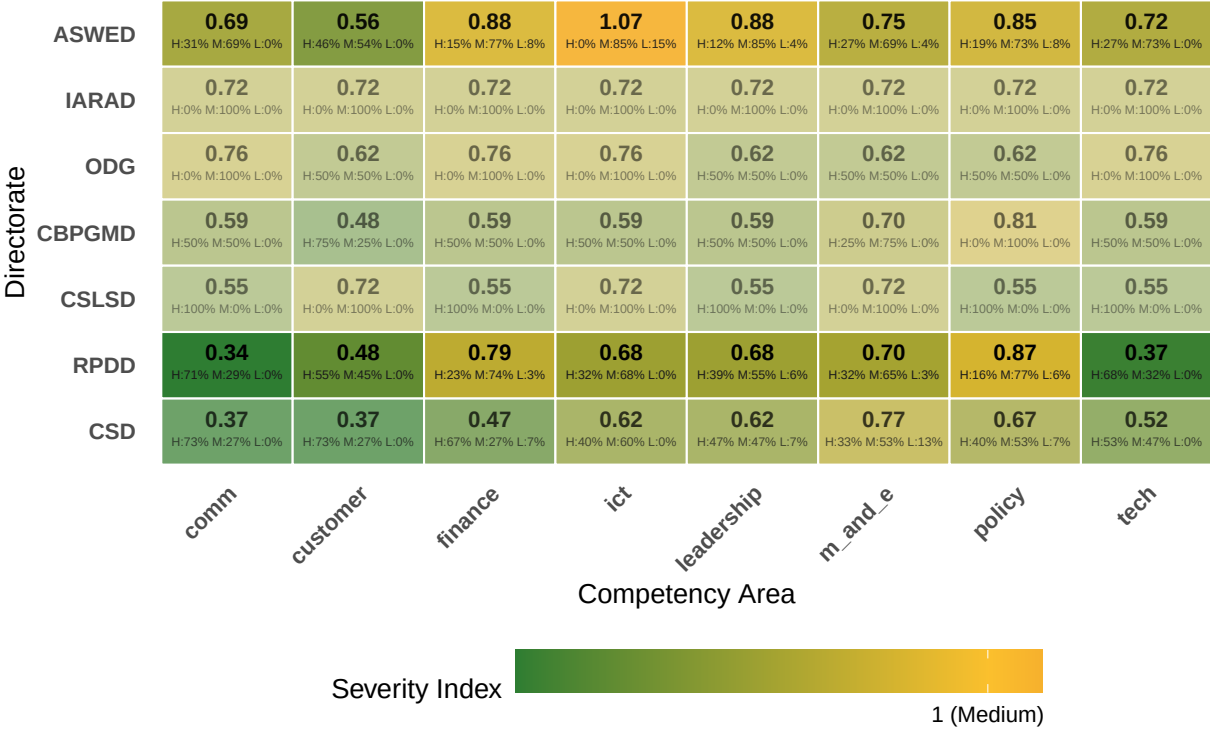
Based on the voluntary sample of 80 respondents, the data highlights a heavily concentrated middle-tier profile where a staggering 87.5% of all participants belong to just five core grades (NM7, NM8, NM10, NM11, and NM12) (see Table 3). This cluster is overwhelmingly driven by NM8, which represents the single largest respondent segment at 28.7% (23 individuals), followed closely by NM10 at 15.0%. Long-tenured staff are heavily represented, with over a third (36.2%) of the entire sample reporting 16 or more years of service. While this high veteran participation indicates deep institutional memory, its concentration within specific cohorts—such as NM11 where 80% of respondents have 16+ years of tenure—likely reflects a strong self-selection bias where long-serving employees felt a greater stake in completing the survey than newer hires. Furthermore, the active participation of both entry-level staff and 16+ year veterans within identical grades (such as NM8 and NM12) indicates that structural bottlenecks or career stagnation are highly visible and sensitive topics among the voluntary respondents.

Objective 1: Perceived skill gaps



Competency Gap Heatmap by Directorate

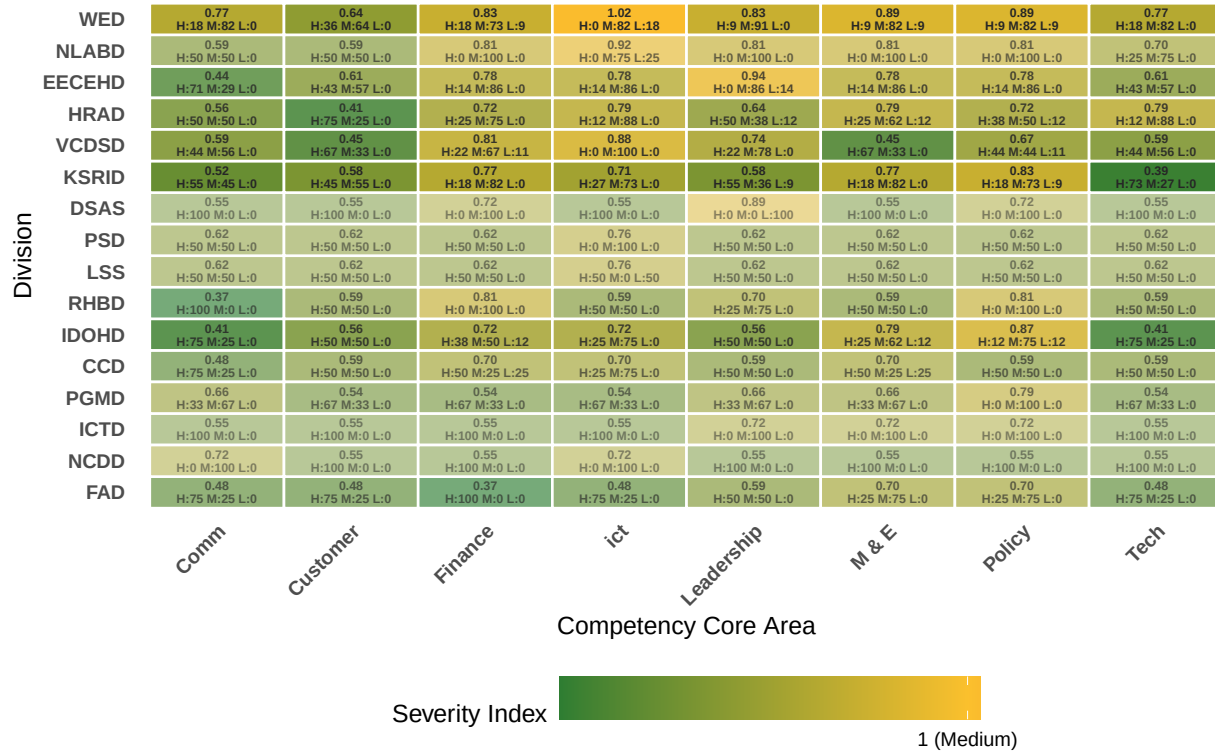
Shrinkage adjusted metrics (Red indicates highest deficiency severity)



Values: High=0, Medium=1, Low=2. Smaller teams are safely shrunk toward global averages to eliminate sample bias.

Competency Gap Heatmap by Division

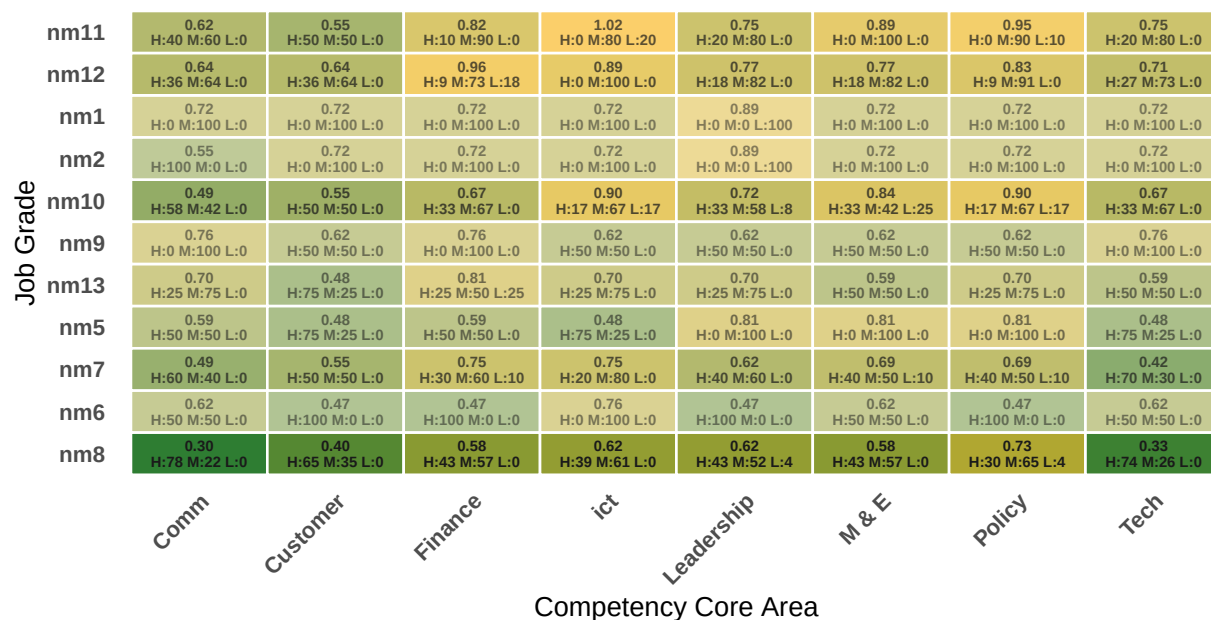
Shrinkage adjusted metrics (Warm tones indicate higher training needs)



Labels show: Adjusted Score (Top) / Employee Skill Breakdowns (Bottom).

Competency Gap Heatmap by Job Grade

Shrinkage adjusted metrics (Warm tones indicate highest deficiency severity)



Severity Index



1 (Medium)

Values: High=0, Medium=1, Low=2. Labels display: Shrunk Score / raw H-M-L percentages.

Objective 2: Perceived impact of past training

Objective 3: Perceived Training priorities

Objective 4: Training delivery preferences

Objective 5: Perceived workplace bottlenecks

Objective 6 : Innovation and innovation readiness

Conclusion and Recommendations

Table 1: Workforce distribution by directorate and division

Division / Section	Staff Count
Animal Sciences Welfare And Ethics Directorate	
Kenya Snakebite Research And Intervention Division	1
Laboratory Services Section	1
National Laboratory Animal Breeding Division	4
Veterinary Clinical And Diagnostics Services Division	9
Welfare And Ethics Division	11
Capacity Building Partnership And Grant Management Directorate	
Human Resource And Administration Division	1
Partnerships And Grants Management Division	3
Corporate Services Directorate	
Corporate Communication Division	4
Finance And Accounts Division	4
Human Resource And Administration Division	5
Information Communication Technology Division	1
Planning And Strategy Division	1
Corporation Secretary Legal Services Directorate	
Infectious Diseases And One Health Division	1
Internal Audit And Risk Assurance Directorate	
Human Resource And Administration Division	1
Office Of The Director General	
Human Resource And Administration Division	1
Planning And Strategy Division	1
Research And Product Development Directorate	
Data Science And Analytics Section	1
Evolutionary Ecology Conservation And Ecosystem Health Division	7
Infectious Diseases And One Health Division	7
Kenya Snakebite Research And Intervention Division	10
Laboratory Services Section	1
Non Communicable Diseases Division	1
Reproductive Health And Biology Division	4

Table 2: Gender distribution across age brackets

Gender	Under 25 years	25-34 years	35-44 years	45-54 years	55+ years	Total
female	8.3% (3)	22.2% (8)	36.1% (13)	27.8% (10)	5.6% (2)	100.0% (36)
male	6.8% (3)	29.5% (13)	15.9% (7)	34.1% (15)	13.6% (6)	100.0% (44)
Total	7.5% (6)	26.2% (21)	25.0% (20)	31.2% (25)	10.0% (8)	100.0% (80)

Table 3: Job grade distribution by length of service (Voluntary Survey)

Job_Grade	Less Than 1 Year	1 3 Years	4 7 Years	8 15 Years	16+ Years	Total	Percentage (%)
NM1	0	1	0	0	0	1	1.2
NM2	0	1	0	0	0	1	1.2
NM5	0	0	0	1	3	4	5.0
NM6	0	0	0	0	2	2	2.5
NM7	0	3	2	2	3	10	12.5
NM8	4	3	9	3	4	23	28.7
NM9	0	0	0	1	1	2	2.5
NM10	0	1	2	4	5	12	15.0
NM11	0	0	1	1	8	10	12.5
NM12	2	5	1	1	2	11	13.8
NM13	0	2	0	1	1	4	5.0

Average Severity Score	High Proficiency (%)	Medium Proficiency (%)	Low Proficiency (%)
0.66	37.00	59.70	3.30

Table 4: Overall Institutional Competency Gap Profile